

Data Governance & Metadata Standards Policy — FY2026

Document Owner: Data Governance Office | Classification: Internal

1. Purpose

This policy defines the mandatory metadata fields required for every dataset ingested into the analytics platform. These requirements exist to ensure traceability, regulatory compliance, and proper sensitivity classification of all structured data assets cataloged via AWS Glue. This policy applies to all CSV and JSON datasets loaded into the data warehouse, regardless of source system or business unit.

2. Required Metadata Fields

Every dataset cataloged in the Glue Data Catalog must include the following fields, either as columns within the dataset itself or as attached table properties. A dataset missing any field marked Mandatory below is considered non-compliant with this policy.

Field Name	Requirement	Description
dataset_owner	Mandatory	Business unit or individual responsible for the dataset
source_system	Mandatory	System of origin for the data
last_updated_date	Mandatory	Date the dataset was last refreshed
data_classification	Mandatory	Sensitivity level: Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted
retention_period_days	Mandatory	Number of days the data must be retained per compliance rules
pii_flag	Mandatory	Boolean indicating whether the dataset contains personally identifiable information
data_quality_score	Recommended	Automated quality score, if available from upstream validation

3. Compliance Requirement

Any dataset cataloged in the Glue Data Catalog that is missing one or more of the Mandatory fields listed in Section 2 is considered non-compliant with this policy and must be flagged for remediation within 10 business days of discovery. Compliance checks are performed monthly by cross-referencing the schema of each cataloged dataset in the Glue Data Catalog against the requirements in this document. Datasets found non-compliant twice in a row are escalated to the Data Governance Office for a mandatory remediation plan.

4. Review Cadence

This policy is reviewed quarterly by the Data Governance Office. Any changes to required fields will be communicated to all data engineering teams at least 30 days prior to enforcement.